Draft - expert review pending

This unit is complete and passes the platform’s automated checks, but no reviewer has read it yet. Treat its sources and claims with care.

Unit 1 assessment

Unit summary

Vocabulary in context means understanding register, collocation, connotation and denotation, not just memorising word lists. Communicative grammar means understanding how grammar creates meaning in real communication: subject-verb agreement, verb tenses, fragments, run-ons, modifiers and articles. Word-formation processes (affixation, compounding, clipping, back formation) explain how English builds new words. Sentence structures (simple, compound, complex, compound-complex) explain how clauses combine. The English sound system has approximately 44 phonemes, several of which do not exist in Urdu, and the most common challenges for Urdu speakers involve the "th" sounds, the "v/w" distinction, final consonant clusters and vowel length.

Summative assessment

Multiple-choice questions (MCQs)

1. In this unit's account, "register" refers to: *(Remember)* a) a list of vocabulary words b) the level of formality a situation demands c) the pronunciation of a word d) the spelling of a word

2. A teacher says, "The pupils in Class 7 reads quietly." This is an example of: *(Understand)* a) a fragment b) a run-on c) a subject-verb agreement error d) a modifier error

3. Which word-formation process creates "exam" from "examination"? *(Remember)* a) Affixation b) Compounding c) Clipping d) Back formation

4. A trainee says, "I am having two brothers." The most likely source of this error is: *(Apply)* a) L1 transfer from Urdu, which uses the present continuous for possession b) overgeneralisation of the present continuous c) confusion between "have" and "has" d) a spelling error

5. How many phonemes does English have, approximately? *(Remember)* a) 26 b) 36 c) 44 d) 52

6. A pupil writes, "Walking to school, the rain started suddenly." The error is: *(Understand)* a) a run-on sentence b) a dangling modifier c) a subject-verb agreement error d) a fragment

7. A pupil pronounces "think" as "tink". The sound causing difficulty is: *(Apply)* a) /s/ b) /t/ c) /θ/ d) /f/

8. Which sentence is a compound-complex sentence? *(Apply)* a) The pupils read their books. b) The pupils read their books and the teacher wrote on the board. c) When the bell rang, the pupils packed their bags. d) When the bell rang, the pupils packed their bags and the teacher left the room.

9. "Edit" was formed from "editor" by removing what looks like a suffix. This is an example of: *(Remember)* a) affixation b) compounding c) clipping d) back formation

10. The difference between "ship" and "sheep" is primarily a difference of: *(Understand)* a) stress b) intonation c) vowel length d) consonant voicing

Restricted-response questions (RRQs)

1. Explain the difference between register and connotation, and give one example of each. *(Remember)*

2. A pupil writes, "The group of students was arguing among themselves." Explain why this sentence is grammatically difficult and identify the rule that applies. *(Analyze)*

3. Name the four word-formation processes and give one example of each. *(Remember)*

4. Classify the following sentence as simple, compound, complex or compound-complex, and explain your reasoning: "After the meeting ended, the teachers went to the staffroom and discussed the new timetable." *(Apply)*

5. A pupil pronounces "vet" as "wet" and "wet" as "vet". Identify the sounds involved and explain why they are difficult for Urdu speakers. *(Analyze)*

6. Explain the difference between stress and intonation, and give one example of each. *(Remember)*

7. A teacher says, "I have been knowing him for ten years." Identify the error and explain why the verb "know" behaves differently from other verbs in this context. *(Analyze)*

8. Rewrite the following sentence so the modifier is not dangling: "Running to school, the rain started suddenly." *(Apply)*

9. Explain why English has more sounds than letters, and describe two challenges this creates for Urdu speakers. *(Understand)*

10. A friend says, "Grammar rules are fixed and universal." Using this unit's account, explain what that claim overlooks. *(Evaluate)*

Extended-response questions (ERQs)

1. A pupil writes: "I am having two brothers and one sister. My father is doing job in a bank. We are living in Lahore since five years." Using this unit's account of communicative grammar, identify four grammatical issues, explain why each is an error, and rewrite the sentences so they are natural and correct. *(Analyze)*

2. A pupil pronounces "ship" and "sheep" the same way, says "tink" for "think", and says "wet" for "vet". Using this unit's account of the English sound system, explain why these errors happen, identify the specific sounds involved, and propose three specific strategies the pupil could use to improve. *(Analyze)*

3. Take a short paragraph from an English textbook used in a Pakistani school. Analyse the paragraph for: (a) five words formed by affixation,

compounding, clipping or back formation, and (b) five sentences classified by structure. Write 400 to 450 words. *(Analyze)*

4. Evaluate the claim that "pronunciation does not matter as long as people understand you." Use this unit's account of the English sound system, register and connotation to argue for or against the claim. *(Evaluate)*

5. **Integrative.** You are placed in a government primary school. The Class 5 English teacher asks you to help pupils who consistently make these errors: "I am having a book", "She go to school yesterday", and "tink" for "think". Design a 30-minute lesson that addresses all three errors, using this unit's account of vocabulary, grammar and pronunciation. Justify each choice. *(Create)*

Answers and marking guidance

MCQ answer key

1. **b** - register is the level of formality a situation demands.
2. **c** - "pupils" is plural but "reads" is singular; this is a subject-verb agreement error.
3. **c** - "exam" is a clipping of "examination".
4. **a** - Urdu uses a continuous construction for possession; L1 transfer is the likely source.
5. **c** - English has approximately 44 phonemes.
6. **b** - the modifier "walking to school" has no clear subject; it is dangling.
7. **c** - the /θ/ sound (voiceless dental fricative) does not exist in Urdu.
8. **d** - two independent clauses ("the pupils packed their bags", "the teacher left the room") and one dependent clause ("when the bell rang").
9. **d** - "edit" was formed by removing "-or" from "editor"; this is back formation.
10. **c** - "ship" (/ɪ/) and "sheep" (/iː/) differ primarily in vowel length.

RRQ model answers and mark schemes

1. (4 marks) Register is the level of formality a situation demands (1); connotation is the feeling or association a word carries beyond its literal meaning (1); the register example is genuinely about formality level (1); the connotation example is genuinely about association (1).

2. (5 marks) Identifies the difficulty: "group" is singular but "themselves" is plural (1); explains the rule: collective nouns take singular verbs when the group acts as a unit (1); notes that British English sometimes accepts plural verbs with collective nouns (1); the reasoning draws on Topic 1.1 (1); the reasoning is coherent (1).

3. (4 marks) Names all four processes: affixation, compounding, clipping, back formation (1 each). One mark per example that correctly illustrates the process (up to 4).

4. (4 marks) Classifies the sentence as compound-complex (1); identifies two independent clauses: "the teachers went to the staffroom" and "discussed the new timetable" (1); identifies the dependent clause: "after the meeting ended" (1); the explanation is coherent (1).

5. (5 marks) Identifies the sounds: /v/ and /w/ (1); explains that Urdu has a sound between the two (1); links this to the confusion (1); the reasoning draws on Topic 1.3 (1); the reasoning is coherent (1).

6. (4 marks) Stress is the relative emphasis on a syllable within a word (1); intonation is the rise and fall of the voice across a phrase or sentence (1); the stress example is genuinely about syllable emphasis (1); the intonation example is genuinely about voice movement (1).

7. (5 marks) Identifies the error: "know" is a stative verb and is not normally used in the continuous form (1); explains that stative verbs describe states, not actions (1); contrasts with dynamic verbs that can be used in the continuous (1); the reasoning draws on Topic 1.1 (1); the reasoning is coherent (1).

8. (3 marks) The rewritten sentence has a clear subject for "running" (1); the modifier is correctly placed (1); the original meaning is preserved (1).

9. (4 marks) English has approximately 44 phonemes but only 26 letters (1); the relationship between spelling and sound is not one-to-one (1); names two challenges (e.g. "th" sounds, vowel length, final clusters) (1 each up to 2).

10. (5 marks) Takes the claim at its strongest (1); explains that grammar describes actual usage, not fixed rules (1); notes that usage varies by region, register and context (1); argues a verdict with reasons (1); the reasoning is coherent (1).

ERQ rubrics

Each ERQ is marked out of 20 on the four criteria below.

ERQ 1 - Grammatical errors in a pupil's writing

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Identification of the four issues	Fewer than three identified	Three identified with evidence	All four identified with evidence
Explanation of why each is wrong	Asserts it is wrong	Explains the grammatical principle	Explains the principle and links it to Urdu L1 transfer
Rewritten sentences (Apply)	**Leaves errors or introduces new ones**	**Corrects most errors**	**Produces natural, correct sentences that preserve meaning**
Register and clarity	Generic	Refers to the description	Writes for a colleague, defines terms

ERQ 2 - Pronunciation challenges

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Explanation of the errors	Names the errors vaguely	Identifies the specific phonemes	Identifies the phonemes and explains why they are difficult for Urdu speakers
Identification of the sounds	Names the sounds without explanation	Names the sounds and explains the difficulty	Names the sounds, explains the difficulty, and links to the English sound system
Proposed strategies (Apply)	**Generic advice**	**Two specific strategies**	**Three specific, practicable strategies**
Register and clarity	Generic	Refers to the description	Writes for a colleague, defines terms

ERQ 3 - Analysing a textbook paragraph

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Coverage of the five words	Fewer than four identified	Four identified with evidence	All five identified with evidence
Coverage of the five sentences	Fewer than four classified	Four classified with evidence	All five classified with evidence
Accuracy of the analysis	**Misclassifies processes or**	**Mostly accurate**	**All examples correctly**

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
(Analyze)	**structures**		**classified**
Register and clarity	Generic	Refers to the description	Writes for a colleague, defines terms, within word count

ERQ 4 - "Pronunciation does not matter"

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Grasp of the sound system	Names the system vaguely	Describes the system accurately	Shows what the system makes visible
Use of register/connotation	Does not reference them	References them	Uses them to argue that clarity is not just about sounds
Evaluative reasoning (Evaluate)	**Asserts a verdict**	**Argues a verdict with reasons**	**Takes the claim at its strongest, then shows what it leaves out**
Quality of example	Generic	Concrete classroom example	The example genuinely illustrates the argument

ERQ 5 - Integrative: a 30-minute lesson

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Coverage of the three errors	Fewer than two addressed	All three addressed	All three addressed with specific activities
Quality of the activities	Vague or generic	Specific and practicable	Specific, practicable, and timed
Justification by unit content (Create)	**Asserts the lesson works**	**Links each activity to the unit**	**Shows how the activity addresses the specific grammatical, lexical or phonological principle**
Realism and register	Ignores the constraints	Acknowledges them	The plan survives the constraints: 30 minutes, Class 5, government school

Tip: select any text on this page first to comment on that specific passage - or leave nothing selected for general feedback.

Give feedback